

District 39 Minutes

June 21, 2026

Treasurer Report (Scotty)	
Beginning Balance	\$1562.00
Prudent Reserve	- \$500.00
Cash on Hand	\$1062.82
Expenses	
Pizza (Workshop)	
Workshop ck # 1357	\$82.78
Workshop ck # 1358	\$329.05
Total Expenses	- \$741.83
Contributions	
Workshop	\$77.00
Groups	\$375.00
District Mgt.	\$130.00
Total Contributions	+ \$482.00
Total Cash On Hand	\$1062.92
Prudent Reserve	+ \$500
Ending Balance	\$1302.99

Visitation (Dewy)

- Absent

Workshop (Ashley)

Thanks to the workshop committee for another successful workshop presentation.

- There were about 100 people in attendance and it lasted about 2 hours
- The workshop collected \$77
- Everyone involved has been paid and all costs are reflected in the treasury report

Sarah (Grapevine)

Grapevine had a table at NEPYAA event. If you would like to schedule a presentation, contact Sarah.

Rob (Booker)

nothing

Marathon

please note there is an upcoming marathon on July 4th; a black and white version of [July 4th Marathon Meeting Flyer](#) is attached. An additional, better-image-quality email will be sent out as the event approaches.

aDCM

The aDCM report was not available

- Ken stepped down for personal reasons; we thank him for his service
- Ashley was nominated and unanimously voted in

- Ashley's nomination to the aDCM chair left an open position at Workshop; Emily was nominated and voted in

DCM (Russel)

- The word "Eskimo" was removed from the Big Book. The issue at hand is that it was done without input from the fellowship; there is no procedure/opportunity to change this decision before the printing of the Big Book.
 - Guidance was provided to DCMs that motions/proposals submitted "should clearly state issue, requested action, and the reason behind it".
 - It was remembered by a member that the guidance for changing the literature should be 2/3 of the membership of AA, but it was interpreted during the meeting where the vote occurred (in New York) as 2/3 of the present voting body
 - *A Motion Was Brought To The Floor for Discussion* by Emily
We ask you bring this motions to your group for discussion

I motion that our district express concern regarding the process of the recent change to the upcoming Fifth Edition of the Big Book and request that the Area Committee and Delegate review the process by which the change was made, with particular attention to whether sufficient opportunity was provided for group conscience input.

Further, I motion that we recommend that future changes to A.A. literature, service materials, or other matters affecting the Fellowship and the A.A. message must be communicated to and discussed by the groups through their GSRs prior to delegates taking positions or casting votes whenever practicable, so that the group conscience remains the foundation of our service structure.

- Additional Notes and thoughts from Emily:
 - Problem of how quickly this decision
 - The triangle of our service structure was flipped, no groups had a say in the matter
 - Eskimo is not derogatory the way it was used here, more importantly why am I so focused on the wording rather than the message that is being carried? If we can't get past the wording in this book, then that's something I need to look at and do some inventory on, the message and principles of our program matter the most and I can't let outside issues or my own personal sensitivities get in the way of that
 - It's not just about one word it's about how this is going against aa's principles and traditions and how there was action taken, changes made without approval
 - Same thing with changing the preamble from men and women to people, this set a precedent, how far will this go?
 - Why are we bringing outside issues in, outside influences are controlling internal processes
 - Not to be drastic but changing these things will lead to AA's collapse
 - If it ain't broke don't FIX IT
 - Second paragraph of preface "because this book has become the basic text for our society and has helped such large numbers of alcoholic men and women to recovery their exist strong sentiment against any radical changes being made in it"... this was stated in advisory actions in the past as well from GSO
 - Also... last paragraph of forward to fourth edition: "While our literature has preserved the integrity of the AA message, sweeping changes in society is a whole are reflected in new customs and practices within the fellowship."

In the 12 & 12, Bill writes that A.A. should avoid concentrating authority in any one person and that trusted servants are not governors. Changes to Conference-approved literature are therefore made only through the group conscience of the Fellowship, not by individuals.

There is also a frequently quoted 2002 General Service Conference recommendation:

- "The text in the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, written by Bill W., remain as is, recognizing the Fellowship's feelings that Bill's writing remain as originally published."
- The concern is not primarily the specific word that was changed. The concern is that a change to our basic text appears to have occurred without meaningful discussion at the group level. Tradition Two tells us that ultimate authority rests in a loving God as expressed through the group conscience. Our first concept tells us that the final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. When decisions affecting the Fellowship are made before groups have had an opportunity to discuss

them, it raises concerns about whether our service structure is functioning as intended.

There's an upcoming survey being done by AA on who is a group vs a meeting; it is important to register as a meeting by registering and getting a registration number.

- they control the Blue Chair App; registering protects you from being removed from any meeting list
- please make groups who don't send representatives aware whenever possible

Registrations are open for [EPGSA](#)

Old Business

- Emily confirmed being district chair
- It was requested future workshops include information on the traditions and service concepts "the purpose is to serve the groups by being a link between traditions, concepts, leadership and groups"
- A question was asked about how we can 'get the word out' about the survey and meeting listings
 - it was suggested that someone should be going to members who is not a home group member at District to inform them
 - A guest asked if there is currently a visitation chair; per bylaws, since the visitation chair was noticed to have been absent for more than 3 consecutive meetings, the position of visitation chair was opened to nominations and a vote
 - Rob was nominated and unanimously accepted.

New Business

There is a motion up for discussion to be brought back to groups

- The motion was not voted on at this meeting
- Please provide feedback from groups via email or at the next district email